Aga Khan University Examination Board

Notes from E-Marking Centre HSSC-II English Compulsory Examination April/ May 2019

Introduction

This document has been produced for the teachers and candidates of HSSC-II course of English Compulsory. It contains comments on candidate responses to the 2019 Higher Secondary School Certificate examination, indicating the quality of the responses and highlighting their relative strengths and weaknesses.

E-Marking Notes

This document includes overall comments on students' performance on every question and *some* specific examples of students' responses which support the mentioned comments. Please note that the descriptive comments represent an overall perception of the better and weaker responses as gathered from the e-marking session. However, the candidates' responses shared (where deemed necessary) in this document represent some specific example(s) of the mentioned comments.

Teachers and candidates should be aware that examiners may ask questions that address the Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs) in a manner that require candidates to respond by integrating knowledge, understanding and application skills they have developed during the course of study. Candidates are advised to read and comprehend each question carefully before writing the response to fulfil the demand of the question.

Candidates need to be aware that the marks allocated to the questions are related to the answer space provided on the examination paper as a guide to the length of the required response. A longer response will not in itself lead to higher marks. Candidates need to be familiar with the command words in the SLOs which contain terms commonly used in examination questions. However, candidates should also be aware that not all questions will start with or contain one of the command words. Words such as 'how', 'why' or 'what' may also be used.

The following is a description of the tasks and skills required for fulfillment of those tasks.

Question No	Question Type	Skills Assessed
1 (a, b, c, d, e)	CRQs on a reading passage	- Ability to understand a reading text on a literal level (main/ sub ideas) - Ability to understand a reading text on inferential level (opinions, evidence, reasoning, cause and effect reading between the lines) - Reasoning skills

2	Cloze Passage	- Ability to read and understand the given text - Ability to provide missing information as per the context of a passage
3 (a, b) 4 (a, b, c)	Letter and Essay Writing	- Ability to develop a formal piece of writing with appropriate focus, organisation and purpose - Ability to persuade, argue, reflect and analyse familiar topics/ situations - Ability to use accurate sentence structure, connective devices, spellings, etc.

Note: Student responses reproduced in this report have not been corrected for grammar, spelling or factual information.

Detailed Comments:

Constructed Response Questions

Question 1

Question 1 was based on a reading passage. It had five sub-parts. Candidates were required to understand the reading passage and accordingly answer the questions asked on various aspects of the passage. The criteria against which marks were allotted are detailed understanding of the contents of the passage demonstrated appropriately in the responses and authentic interpretation and discussion of different aspects of the passage. Careful reading of a question and reading passage is vital if a student is to attain high marks.

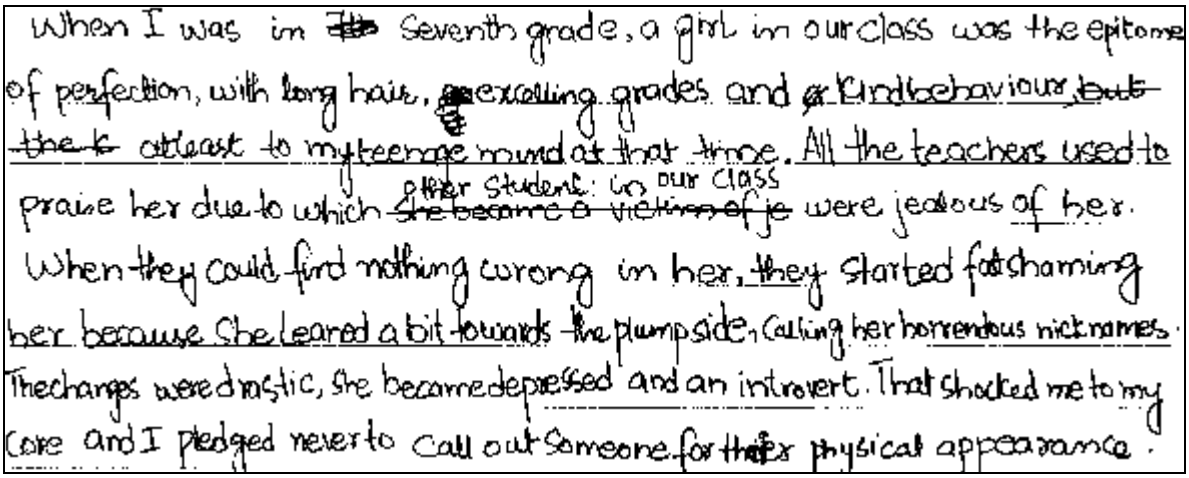
The passage assessed was taken from past paper. The passage was an article - '*Fat-Shaming is Not Community Service*'- by Faraz Talat.

Question 1a:

Based on your experience, briefly narrate an account when you saw someone being fat-shamed and the impact it had on you.

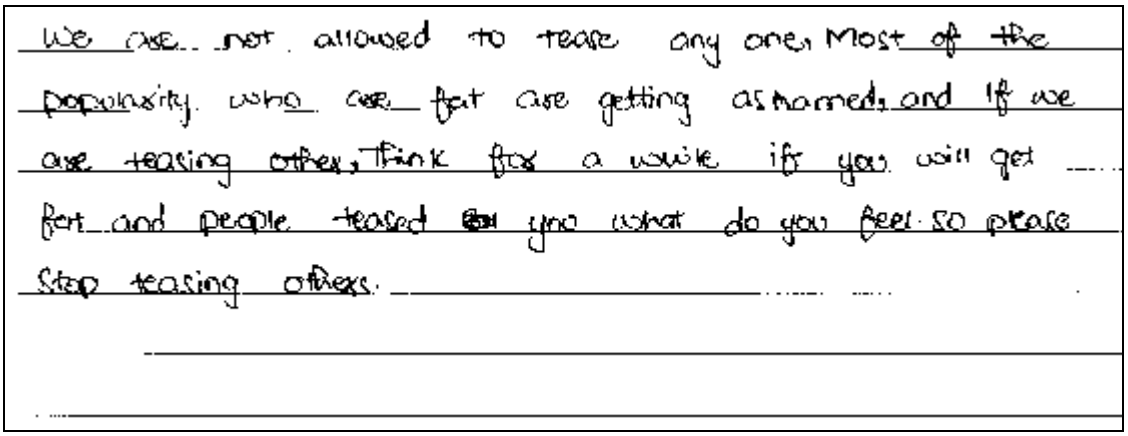
It was found that in *better responses,* the candidates' tone was solemn and one of seriousness. Most of the better responses indicated fat-shaming in schools and the despicable effects it had on the victim. The responses invoked empathy through their experiences.

Example:


When I was in ~~the~~ Seventh grade, a girl in our class was the epitome of perfection, with long hair, excelling grades and ~~a~~ kind behaviour, ~~but the~~ atleast to my teenage mind at that time. All the teachers used to praise her due to which ~~she became a victim of je~~ other student in our class were jealous of her. When they could find nothing wrong in her, they started fat shaming her because she leared a bit towards the plump side, calling her horrendous nicknames. The changes were drastic, she became depressed and an introvert. That shocked me to my core and I pledged never to call out someone for their physical appearance.

Weaker Responses showed an inability to comprehend the seriousness of the issue by giving generic answers with little sympathy towards individuals who were fat-shamed. Some did not narrate the experience and, instead, gave their opinion on fat-shaming.

Example:



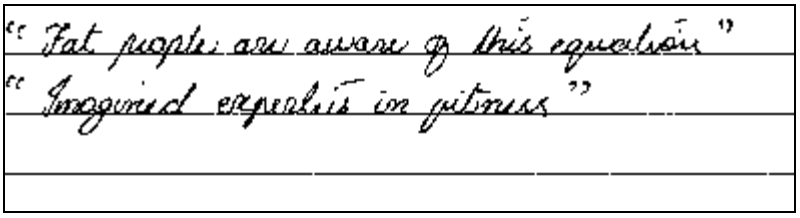
Question 1b:

Mention any TWO phrases from paragraph 2 which indicate sarcasm.

Better responses correctly identified the phrases that indicated sarcasm from paragraph 2. A few accepted answers of the candidates were as follows:

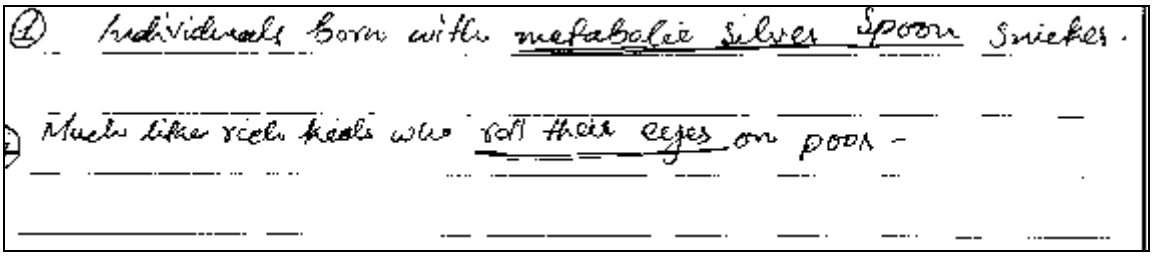
- Fat people are aware of this equation
- Evidence of ignorance of this golden formula
- Thin people feel better about their own bodies and are imagined expertise in fitness

Example:



Many weaker responses also correctly identified the sarcastic phrases but from other paragraphs, rather than from paragraph 2. Answers such as, 'metabolic silver spoons' and 'fat cats' were not assigned marks because the terms/ phrases were from other paragraphs albeit, sarcastic.

Example:



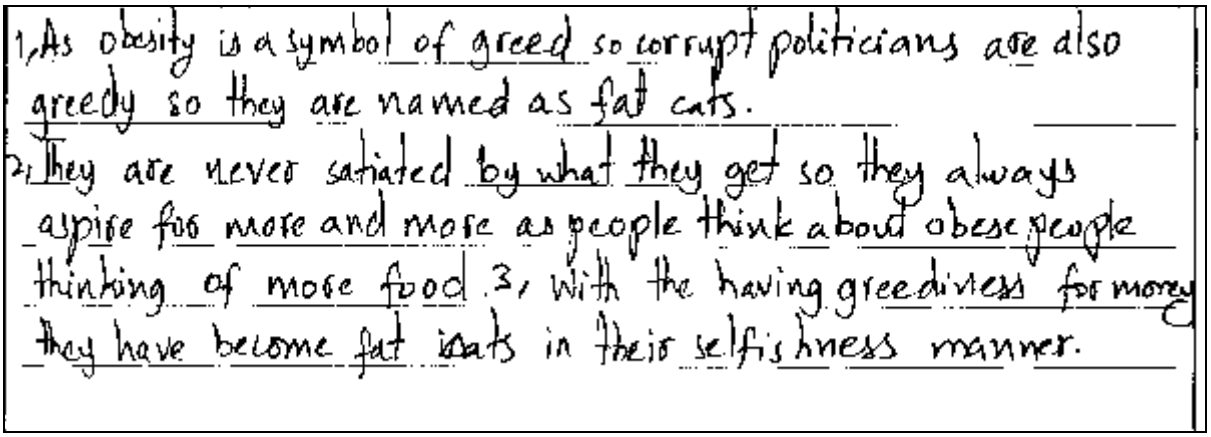
Question 1c:

Describe, in your own words, why would the author use the expression 'fat cats' in paragraph 8 for "corrupt politicians and bureaucrats" in THREE points.

Better responses offered an insightful understanding of the purpose behind the author's reference to corrupt politicians and bureaucrats as 'fat cats'. The observations of the candidates varied but were similar in their responses to the question by stating that the author reflects general (bias) perception, i.e. it

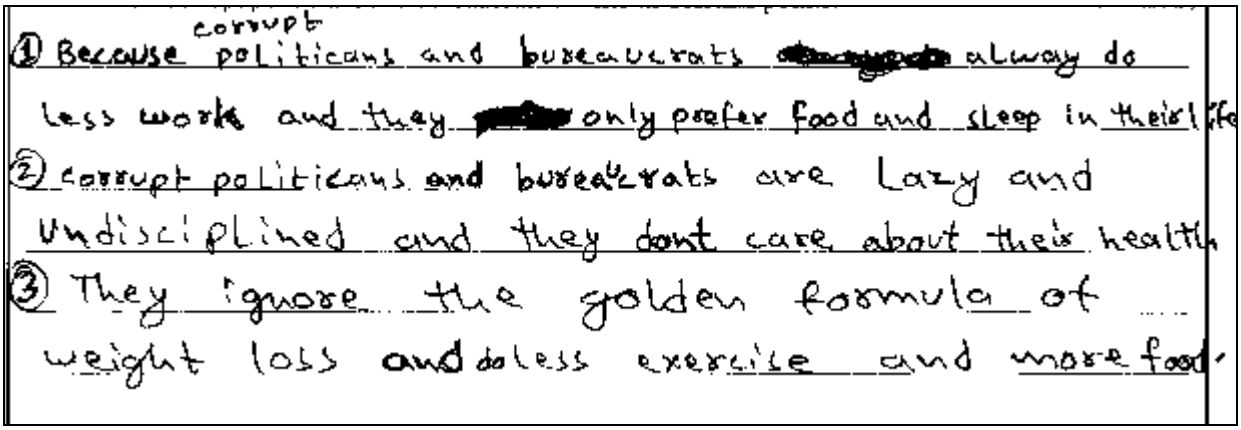
- equates obesity with corrupt politicians and bureaucrats due to their appetite for exploitation/ manipulation of resources, etc.
- draws an analogy. Usually, obese people are observed not to be doing any exercises therefore, the politicians and bureaucrats also sit idly in their offices doing unproductive work.
- is sarcastically and shows a negative attitude toward politicians and bureaucrats.

Example:



Weaker responses reinstated what the author stated in the article by copying phrases from the passage. Some also described the politicians' physique to be 'fat' and 'obese' which not a demand of the question.

Example:



Question 1d:

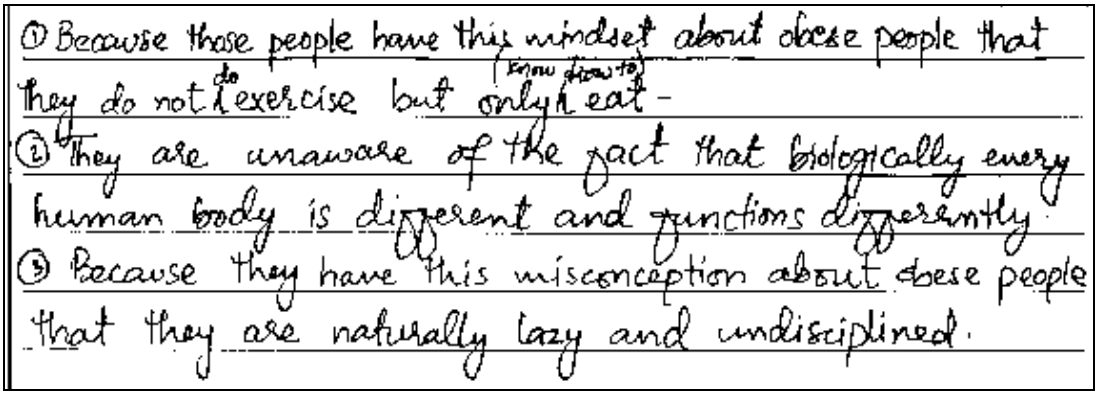
Sometimes people may unintentionally fat-shame those individuals who are struggling with obesity.

With reference to the given passage, describe THREE causes behind such behaviour.

This was a much better attempted question as candidates' *better responses* exhibited an in-depth analysis of the causes behind fat-shaming. Some of the causes included

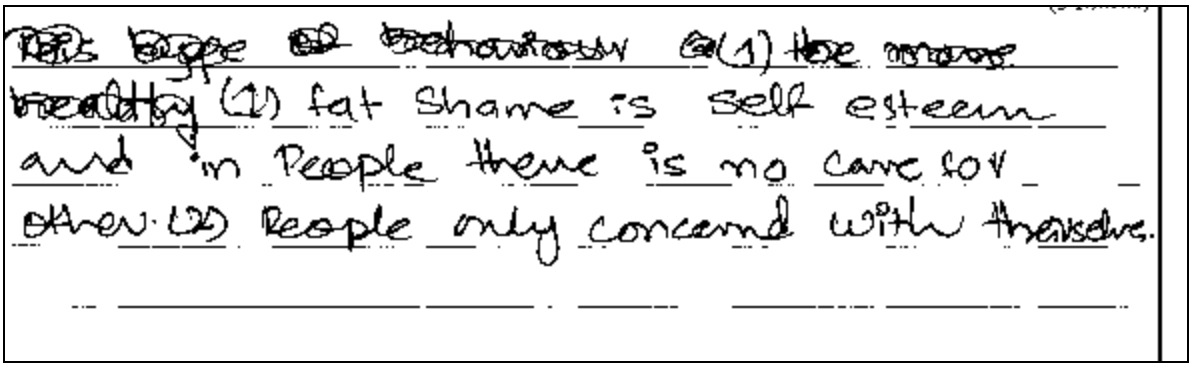
- the societal and cultural endorsements to bullies to victimise people who don't fit a certain criteria of a healthy body.
- The lack of awareness regarding the 'obese-gene' and the various body types that exist.
- advertising on the television which shows preference towards skinny people who are preferred over other body types.

Example:



Weaker responses completely misunderstood the context of the question and wrongly described fat-shaming to be much esteemed. Some responses offered no justification behind the causes of fat-shaming offering advice on how to lose weight instead.

Example:

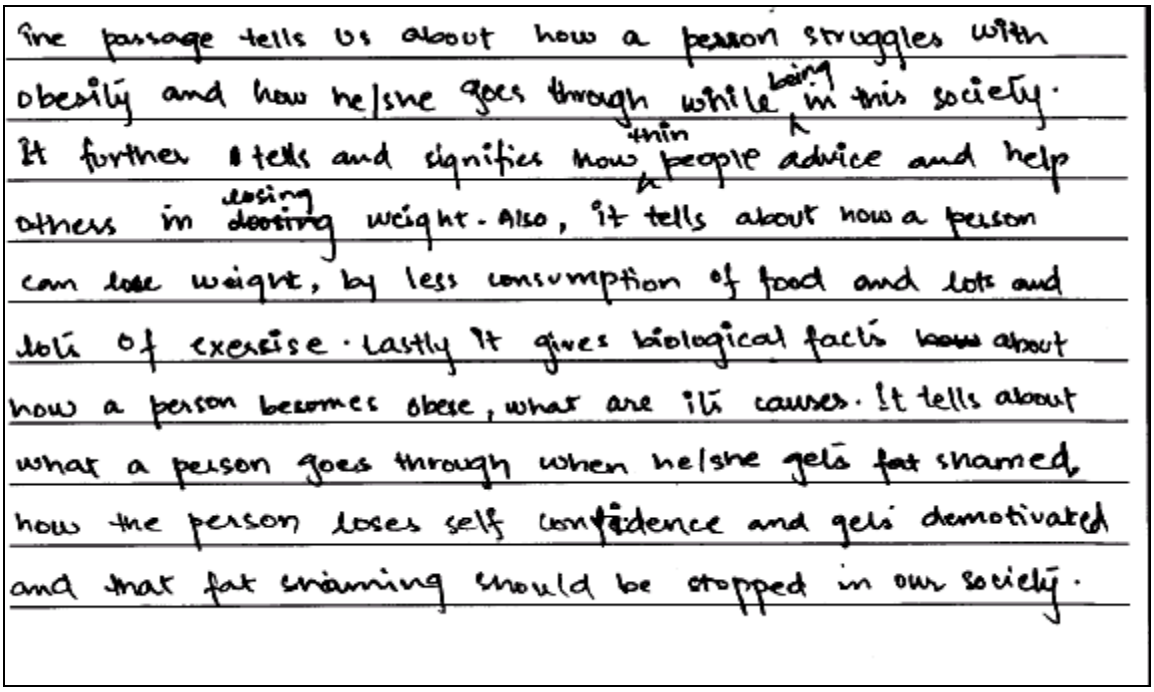


Question 1e:

Summarise the given passage in no more than 100 words.

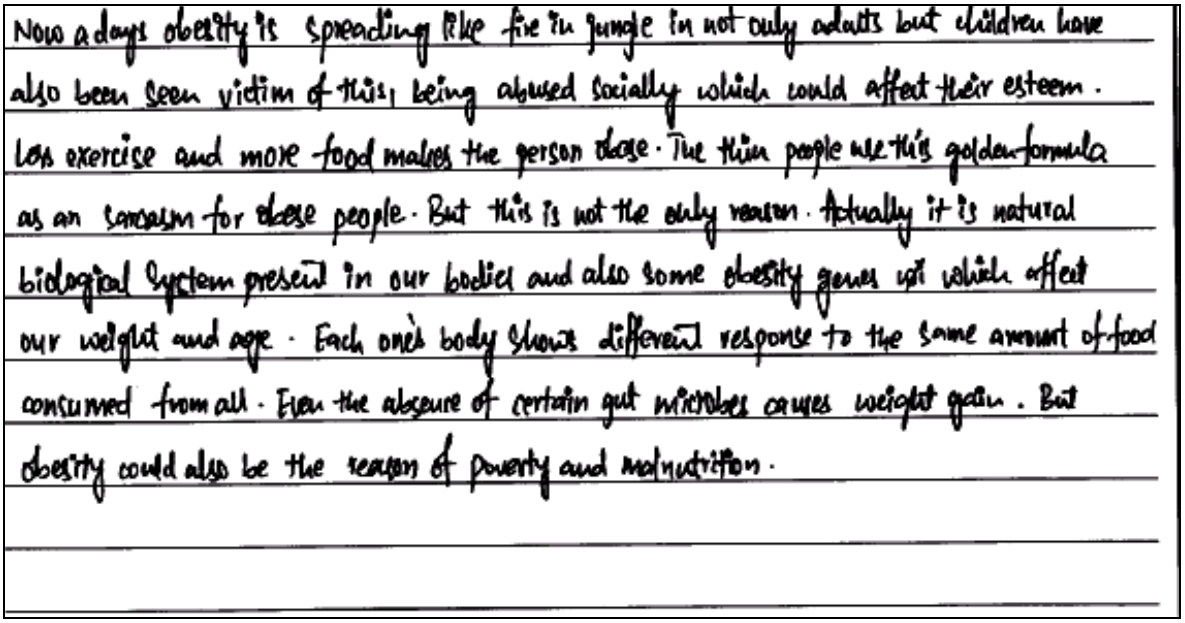
This was a generally well-attempted question. In *better responses*, candidates extracted main ideas from the passage and rephrased them in a coherent summary. Most of these responses did correctly interpret the main message of the passage, i.e. fat-shaming is a negative action and should be avoided. However, few better responses did not manage to extract this point.

Example:


The passage tells us about how a person struggles with obesity and how he/she goes through while being in this society. It further tells and signifies how thin people advice and help others in loosing weight. Also, it tells about how a person can lose weight, by less consumption of food and lots and lots of exercise. Lastly it gives biological facts know about how a person becomes obese, what are ill causes. It tells about what a person goes through when he/she gets fat shamed, how the person loses self confidence and gets demotivated and that fat shaming should be stopped in our society.

Weaker responses demonstrated a limited understanding of the contents of the passage. Such responses were observed to include points that were not in the passage and write their own opinion regarding the article and the issue presented in the passage. In other weaker responses, the candidates copied whole paragraphs from the text.

Example:


Now a days obesity is spreading like fire in jungle in not only adults but children have also been seen victim of this, being abused socially which could affect their esteem. Less exercise and more food makes the person obese. The thin people use this golden formula as an sarcasm for obese people. But this is not the only reason. Actually it is natural biological system present in our bodies and also some obesity genes in which affect our weight and age. Each one's body shows different response to the same amount of food consumed from all. Even the absence of certain gut microbes causes weight gain. But obesity could also be the reason of poverty and malnutrition.

Question 2:

Read the passage carefully and fill in each of the blanks with ONE suitable word.

The candidates were given a cloze passage to assess their comprehension skills in grammar. This question could be regarded as the most challenging for the candidates. Very few candidates scored full marks. It should be communicated that whilst solving a cloze text, candidates must pay attention to the meaning the passage is trying to convey.

It was observed in *better responses* that the candidates chose appropriate words, prepositions and forms of words to fill in the blanks.

Example:

The first significant 1) actions towards legally protecting the high seas are to take place 2) at the United Nations (UN) in New York. These waters, defined as the open ocean, far from coastlines, are threatened by deep-sea mining, over-fishing and the patenting of marine genetic resources.

Over the next two years, government representatives aim to hammer out a binding agreement to protect them against over-exploitation. But 3) many nations, including the United States, are lukewarm towards the proposal.

Experts 4) say that the oceans of the world are vital for a number of reasons. Scientists say that they capture around 90% of the extra heat and about 26% of the excess carbon dioxide created by humans through the burning of fossil fuels 5) and other activities.

"The half of our planet which is high seas is protecting terrestrial life from the worst impacts of climate change," said Prof Alex Rogers from Oxford University, United Kingdom, who 6) has provided evidence to inform the UN treaty process getting under way on Tuesday.

The high seas are defined as the oceans 7) which lie beyond exclusive economic zones. These zones are usually within 370 km of a country's coastline. These waters cover one and a half times the total land area of the planet and are home 8) to some of the rarest and most charismatic species – but all countries have the right to navigate, fly over, carryout scientific research and fish on the high seas without restriction.

Some whale-hunting countries, such as Japan, Iceland and Norway, are said to be cautious about the idea because they fear it will restrict 9) their fishing operations. Russia is also said to be dragging its feet.

Campaigners, though, are optimistic that eventually 10) a deal will be reached.

Weaker responses showed lack of the candidates' comprehension skills while completing the given cloze passage. Most candidates wrote two words in one given space which was not required by the question. Candidates should focus on the context of the cloze passage to deduce appropriate terminologies to be used in the given spaces. Marks were deducted if the candidates did not apply the rules of subject-verb agreement within the passage.

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Question 3

Question 3a:

Pakistan is a developing country with a larger number of working class individuals. The country is being troubled with many issues such as economic inflation (rising prices of goods) and shortage of resources.

Write an email to the Editor of a renowned newspaper. In your email,

- highlight the impact of economic inflation and shortage of resources on the society.
- suggest TWO solutions for the mentioned issues to the government through the newspaper.

This was attempted by few candidates.

Note: It was observed that even in better responses a few candidates wrote their real names, schools and/ or address. It is prohibited to reveal your identity. Teachers need to inform the candidates to avoid using their real names, schools or addresses in the examination.

The candidates followed the format of an email and demonstrated maturity while responding to the writing task. In *better responses*, the

- ideas were clearly expressed in a wide range of effective and/ or interesting language.
- content was expressed in appropriate vocabulary, informal tone and style by taking into account the nature of relationship with, and the interests of, the recipient.
- candidates opined that the main reason behind such economic disparity was attributed to IMF loans, the rising dollar/ pound in the market, and the fall of the rupee which is giving rise to unemployement.
- impacts mentioned were, unemployment, rising poverty rates, corruption, lawlessness amongst others.
- solutions suggested were to increase outsourced goods and to work on the infrastructure of the country by focusing on the sectors of education, health and finance.

Example:

Option a

To: johnbernard @mail.com

C.C: mnzaopt @outlook.com

Subject: Impact of Economic Inflation and its Solutions.

Respected Sir

Through your esteemed newspaper I would like to share my views and opinions about a highly tormenting and alarming issue faced by our country Pakistan.

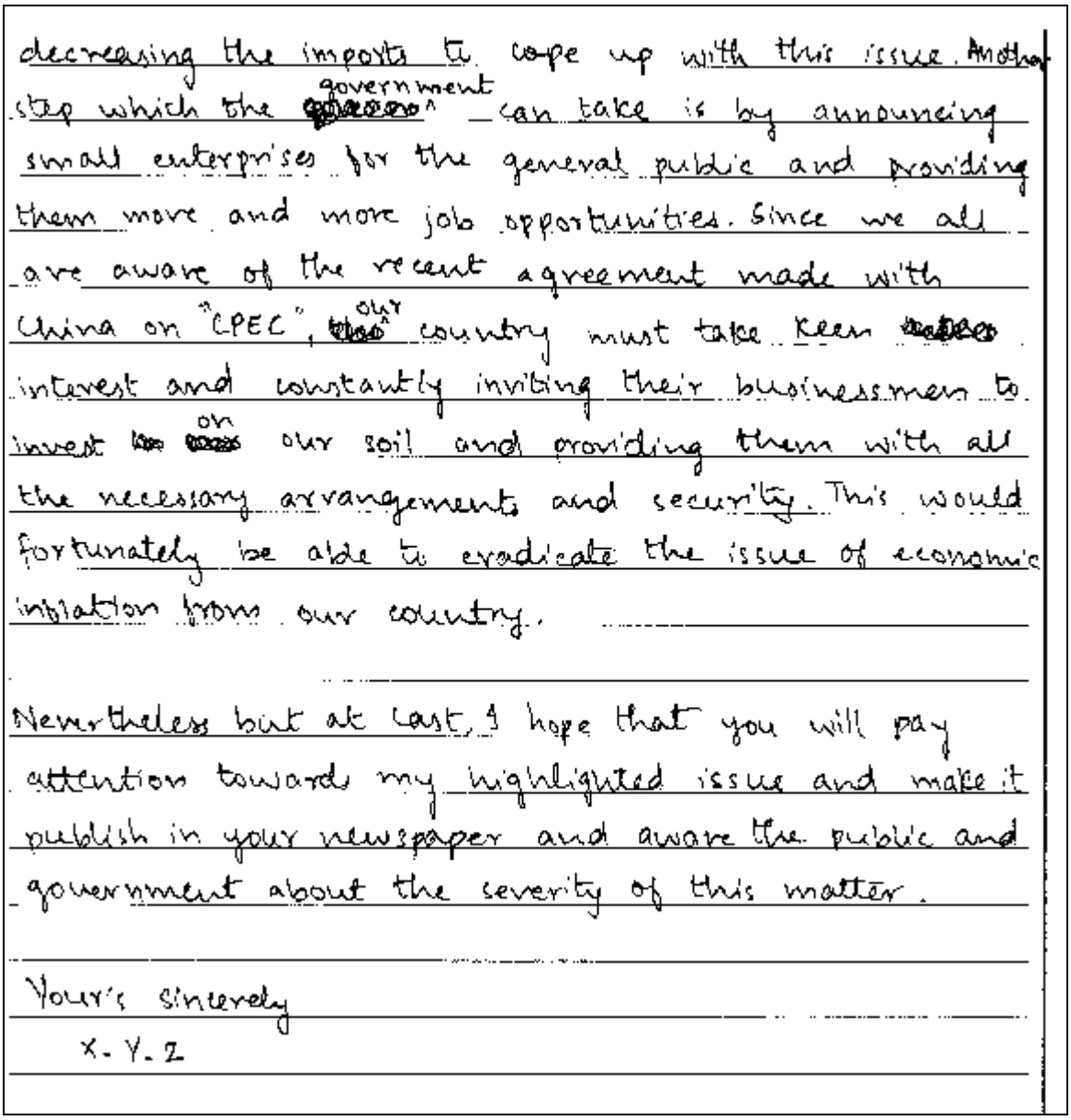
We know that recently a new government has undertaken the seat of President and Prime minister and the Senate. But from last few months we have watched an abrupt rise in the prices of goods and other household items significantly. Leading cause behind this is our own country's economic backwardness. This situation has highly impacted those working class individuals who are working tirelessly to gather a penny by penny for their children's education and for household use.

Ignoring the fact that these circumstances are occurring due to our country's backward economic status rather than due to

the influx of new government, we start to blame and label politicians as corrupt. Rising economic inflation in the country has also given rise to riots and protests in many cities and has led to shortage of resources in the environment. This leading aggression and violence amongst the general public about this issue is common but the people must also realize that its not the fault of the current government or their ignorance towards this issue, they are taking steps according to their thought through which the economy of Pakistan may boost.

Pakistan is not the only country which is facing economic inflation, there are many other countries who are facing this issue extensively for centuries. Few of them have also gone through civil wars or famine due to inflation. On the other hand, our country officials have started taking few steps to boost the economy and reduce inflation in the near future which includes inviting overseas Pakistani and International businessmen to invest in our country so that number of job opportunities for our citizens may also increase simultaneously.

According to my own mindset the steps which the government can undertake for the solution of these problems is by increasing the exports of our country and



decreasing the imports to cope up with this issue. Another step which the government can take is by announcing small enterprises for the general public and providing them more and more job opportunities. Since we all are aware of the recent agreement made with China on "CPEC", our country must take keen interest and constantly inviting their businessmen to invest on our soil and providing them with all the necessary arrangements and security. This would fortunately be able to eradicate the issue of economic inflation from our country.

Nevertheless but at last, I hope that you will pay attention towards my highlighted issue and make it publish in your newspaper and aware the public and government about the severity of this matter.

Your's sincerely

X. Y. Z

Weaker Responses did not elaborate on the impact of economic inflation and scarcity of resources, neither were the solutions mentioned to combat the issue. The candidates, instead, wrote on the importance of market goods and their various characteristics. Such responses also demonstrated inaccurate language structures and punctuation marks. These responses also failed to conclude their letters with a complimentary cloze.

Example:

Examination Hall.
A- B- C
X- Y Z.
30 April 2019.

The Editor.
Dawn newspapes
X-Y-Z.

Subject: Issues faced by our country.

Respected Sir,

We are well aware of the current situations of our country. ~~Though it is easy for us to overcome.~~ It is not possible for us even to fulfill our basic necessities. ~~We want to believe~~ We do not even get basic goods. and the thing that are availble in the market are so expensieve that we can not bother to bly those goods.

Question 3b:

An advertisement firm is looking for a young freelance (work from home) researcher for their firm. You have suitable academic qualifications and skills for this position; therefore, you are interested to apply for the job.

Write a covering letter and develop a suitable CV to apply for the given position. Include the following details in your covering letter:

- Why you are a suitable candidate?
- How would this job help you in developing your career?

(**Note**: The content of the covering letter and CV should be realistic, considering that you are a student of Grade XII.)

This was the most popular choice for the candidates as more than 75% attempted this question. Previously, it was observed that candidates used to write unrealistic CVs by not keeping in mind their Grade. However, in this examination session, most of the candidates kept intermediate as their highest academic qualification.

Better responses indicated the candidates' professional approach to writing a CV and a covering letter. These responses

- communicated their objectives and reasons for applying for the job by stating researches and describing their personality.
- created a résumé with complete information (personal, educational and professional) and an appropriate format of a résumé (having headings and bullets).
- mentioned the educational and professional summary in descending order while writing a résumé.
- used appropriate vocabulary to describe their suitability for the potential employment
- showed command over language structures: grammar, punctuation, spelling, etc.

Example:

Option B (covering letter)

Jinnah College,
Saddar,
Karachi.

Dated: 30th April 2019

HR Department,
New Jobs Co.,
Karachi.

Subject: JOB APPLICATION FOR THE POSITION OF A FREELANCER.

Dear Sir,

Please find my enclosed application along with this letter for the position of a freelancer as advertised on Rozee.pk on Monday, 15th April 2019.

I have passed by HSSC I examinations with A-grade and I am currently a student of HSSC II waiting for the results of it as I have recently given my exams. I have always been a bright student and passed my SSC exams with an A-1 grade. Furthermore, apart from being a bright student academically I was active in many other activities too. I have been a member of the students council and have won many ~~sports~~ races.

Besides this I have also won a second prize from the LUMS literary competition. Being a student at Aptech, I also have a certificate in

program. Moreover, I actively take part in
volunteering programs.

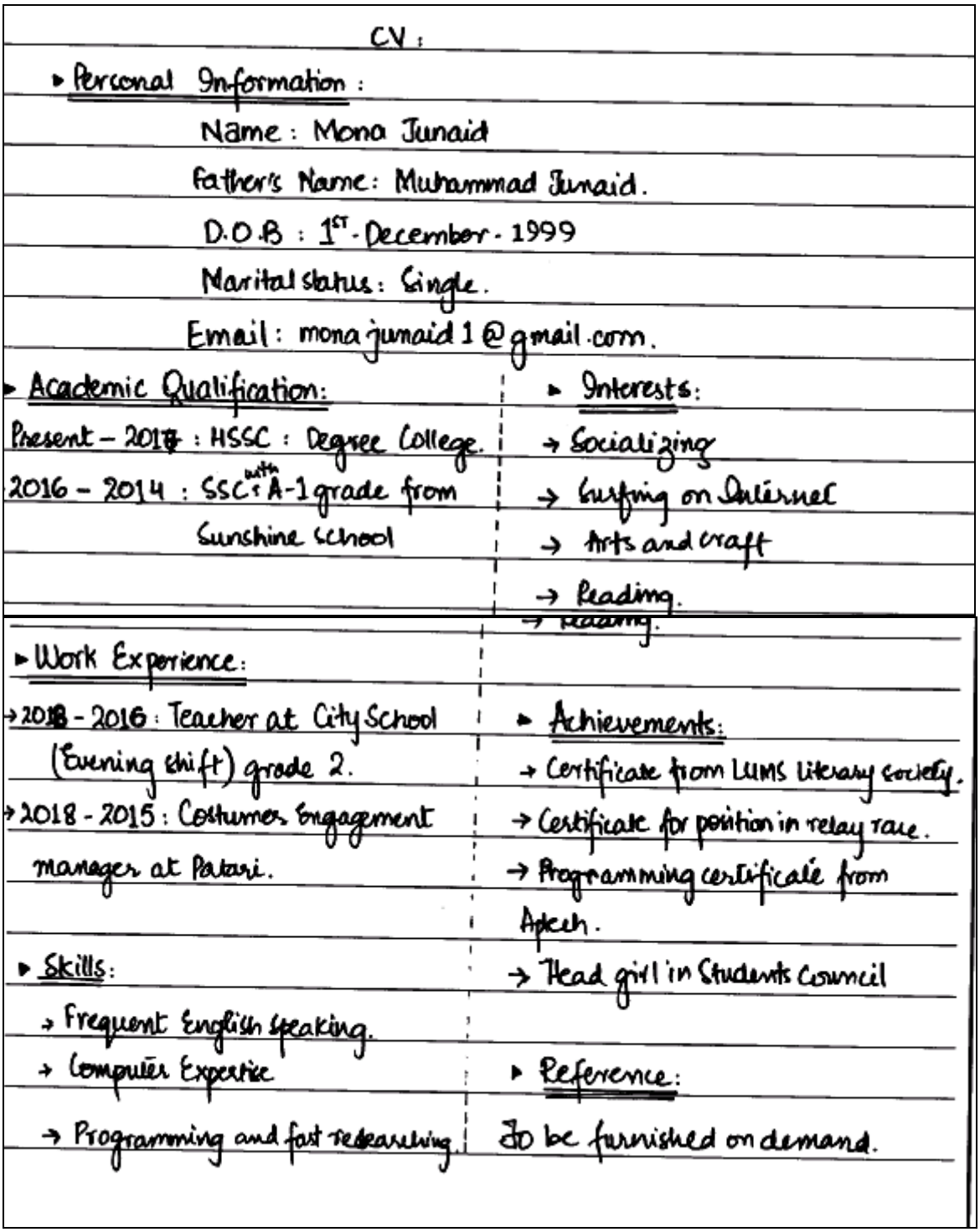
I always enjoy working and for that I was appreciated at all the places I have worked before. The tasked given to me were always completed on time and the researches which they demanded were appreciated too.

For the undergraduate degree, I wish to opt ~~for~~ and apply for communication design which requires interaction with people and with the new researches. By this job, I can benefit myself by providing the research or information the firm demand from me. This will help me in all aspects.

I assure you to fulfill your expectations regarding the tasks you give me and be as hardworking and punctual as I am.

Yours Sincerely,

Mona Junaid



CV :

▸ Personal Information :

Name : Mona Junaid

Father's Name : Muhammad Junaid.

D.O.B : 1ST - December - 1999

Marital status : Single.

Email : monajunaid1@gmail.com.

▸ Academic Qualification:

Present – 2018 : HSSC : Degree College.

2016 – 2014 : SSC with A-1 grade from Sunshine school

▸ Interests :

→ Socializing

→ Surfing on Internet

→ Arts and craft

→ Reading.

→ Reading.

▸ Work Experience :

→ 2018 - 2016 : Teacher at City School (Evening shift) grade 2.

→ 2018 - 2015 : Costumer Engagement manager at Pakari.

▸ Skills :

→ Frequent English speaking.

→ Computer Expertise

→ Programming and fast researching.

▸ Achievements :

→ Certificate from LUMS literary society.

→ Certificate for position in relay race.

→ Programming certificate from Apkeh.

→ Head girl in Students Council

▸ Reference :

To be furnished on demand.

Weaker responses

- exhibited unclear sentence structures with various grammatical errors.
- generalised, redundant or disconnected content/ ideas.
- either wrote a covering letter or a résumé.
- did not mention the required skills needed for the required job position.
- wrote full paragraphs underneath relevant headings for the CV instead of using phrases.

Example:

Name: X-Y-Z Baigal Khan

Email: Baigal0007@gmail.com

address: Baigal colony Gilgit

contact: 03555555503

* Carrer Goals:

Being an energetic, enthusiastic and a biological student. It is my desire to build a firm for my self in my future. I am interested in animals and love alot of them. Being a part of your this reputed firm my dream come to true. Where I learn alot regarding to different animals.

* Qualification

Aga Khan University Examination Board for Pakistan.

- HSSC : Aga Khan Higher Secondary School A-B-C Grade 'A', 2015-2017
- SSC : Aga Khan Higher Secondary School A-B-C Grade 'A', 2017-2019

* Experience

-> Being a part of rural area. I have experience in many different animals like cows, goats, sheeps, Hens

and etc.

⇒ My whole family is working in their firm which is very small, and I am the person who looked after all animals and provide them food.

⇒ I worked under the AKDN for six months to explore the different firms and study them.

*Achievements

-> Got a certificate from AKDN due to exploring different firm and collect information regarding to animals.

->

Examination Hall

city : A-B-C Gilgit Baltistan.

Date : 30 May 2019

To : The Genral Manager of department of Pet firm Gilgit Baltistan.

Subject :

Dear Sir

On this morning when I opened my eyes and see the newspaper beside my bed. It is my daily routine to skim the newspaper. During skimming

I. across your news that your firm need a fresh young and energetic student of FSC. Part II as a firm researcher. I become more excited when I saw your news.

Being a fresh candidate of FSC. part II as a biological student. It is my desire to built a firm in my future. to my self. I am interested in animals. I think that it is a good source to earn money from animals. Most of our people think that animals are wastage of our time and not provide benifits for them. But it is totally wrong animals are well creature of Gnod and we should take care of them. It is my nature that I love animals more than the people.

So, it is a golden opportunity for me to join your firm and I hope it will provide and facilitate me to build my own firm in future. Thanks for your precious time to over view my details. I hope and wait for your positive response

Your sincirely

X Y. Z.

Question 4

The students were directed to give an elaborate response to the essay question. Their responses to the writing composition questions were marked against the given tasks. Responses were marked for their content relevance, vocabulary, structure, expression and overall impression. It was found that all of the given options, a, b, c, were equally preferred by the candidates.

Question 4a:

Carbonated drinks, commonly known as soft drinks, are heavily marketed on various media, including posters and television commercials. However, research has shown that regular consumption of carbonated drinks leads to many health issues, including calcium deficiency.

Write a persuasive essay expressing your views about marketing of carbonated drinks. In your essay, mention

- your opinion regarding such marketing practices.
- at least THREE reasons to support your stance.
- at least ONE effect of marketing of carbonated drinks.

Better responses displayed

- clear ideas expressed in a wide range effective and often interesting language.
- ideas that were expressed in a logical sequence.
- content reflective of appropriate vocabulary, informal tone and style.
- use of a variety of sentence structures in all paragraphs.
- cohesive devices (nevertheless, moreover, and therefore etc.) to provide details and expand ideas.
- considerable knowledge and insight in to the content of the selected task.
- appreciation/ understanding of the effects of marketing carbonated drinks.
- the ability to critically evaluate their own opinion regarding marketing of the drinks by justifying their stance.

Example:

Option a

In this era of technology and artificial intelligence, the researches and discoveries are of immense benefit to marketing, advertising, telecommunication and ~~various~~ various other firms. These companies employ different methods to increase their sales and hence, amplifying their annual productivity, in a way they would have never imagined before. Different companies, brands and retailers spend millions and billions of their capital income in conducting researches and appointing psychologists to in order to determine how can earn greater that they did a day before. But have you thought that how do they convince human minds? How minds and their ~~dese~~ decisions impact the human body?

To begin with, let's take an ~~enem~~ example of soft drinks under consideration. Even though soft drinks are not a healthy option for a balanced life style but the way they are advertised in commercials and posters makes it inevitable for the people to consume them. Advertising agencies would somehow ~~convice~~ convince ~~readers' minds to~~ viewer's mind to consume a soft drink which ultimately has an adverse effect on his body. ~~Sup~~ Surprisingly, the agencies aim at ~~targetting~~ focusing the children because it is far more easier to convince a child when compared to an adult and also due to the fact that habits nurtured in early life ~~o~~ leave a foot print for the rest of the life.

In order to support my ~~o~~ opinion regarding the techniques employed by the marketing firms, a few evidences are presented ahead. ~~Fi~~ First of all, the commercials become very common and can be frequently seen on print and electronic

during summers, when people are in search of different ways to combat the heat. Secondly, the commercials mostly depict that the soft drinks are very cool and refreshing rather that than revealing the hidden truth of being packed with carbon dioxide and sugar. Lastly, influencers such as famous bloggers, celebrities and other famous personalities are employed to further compel the people to consume the products.

Speaking of carbonated drinks, they are rich reservoirs of carbondioxide, sugars and toxic chemicals. Regardless of successful advertisements, commercials and promotion of the brands, these have adverse effects on human health. Surprisingly no one would ever tell you the bitter reality of these products. Consuming such beverages can lead to ~~pancreatic and gastric ulc~~ gastric ulcers due to their acidic nature, respiratory problems due to higher percentage of carbon dioxide, degeneration of bones due to decline in calcium level and may induce aging as well due deterioration of body functions if consumed in higher amounts.

To sum up, I would like to state that it is the responsibility of government officials and authority holders to ensure the ~~health~~ well-being of citizens of the country. This could only occur if a policies regarding the mass advertisement of unhealthy products should be constructed so ~~they that~~. These should be replaced by healthier products marketed advertised in the same way so as to ~~induce~~ promote a healthy ~~live~~ life style ~~about~~ among the public in order to ~~be~~ build a much stronger nation.

Weaker responses failed to comprehend the required task. The responses mentioned the harmful effects of carbonated drinks, whereas, the harmful effects of marketing carbonated drinks was asked. Such responses also demonstrated inconsistency in language, often using informal tone.

Some such responses mentioned that carbonated drinks should be registered as a healthy drink even though the essay prompt clearly mentions their adverse effects on a person's health. Moreover, there was no cohesion amongst the paragraphs.

Example:

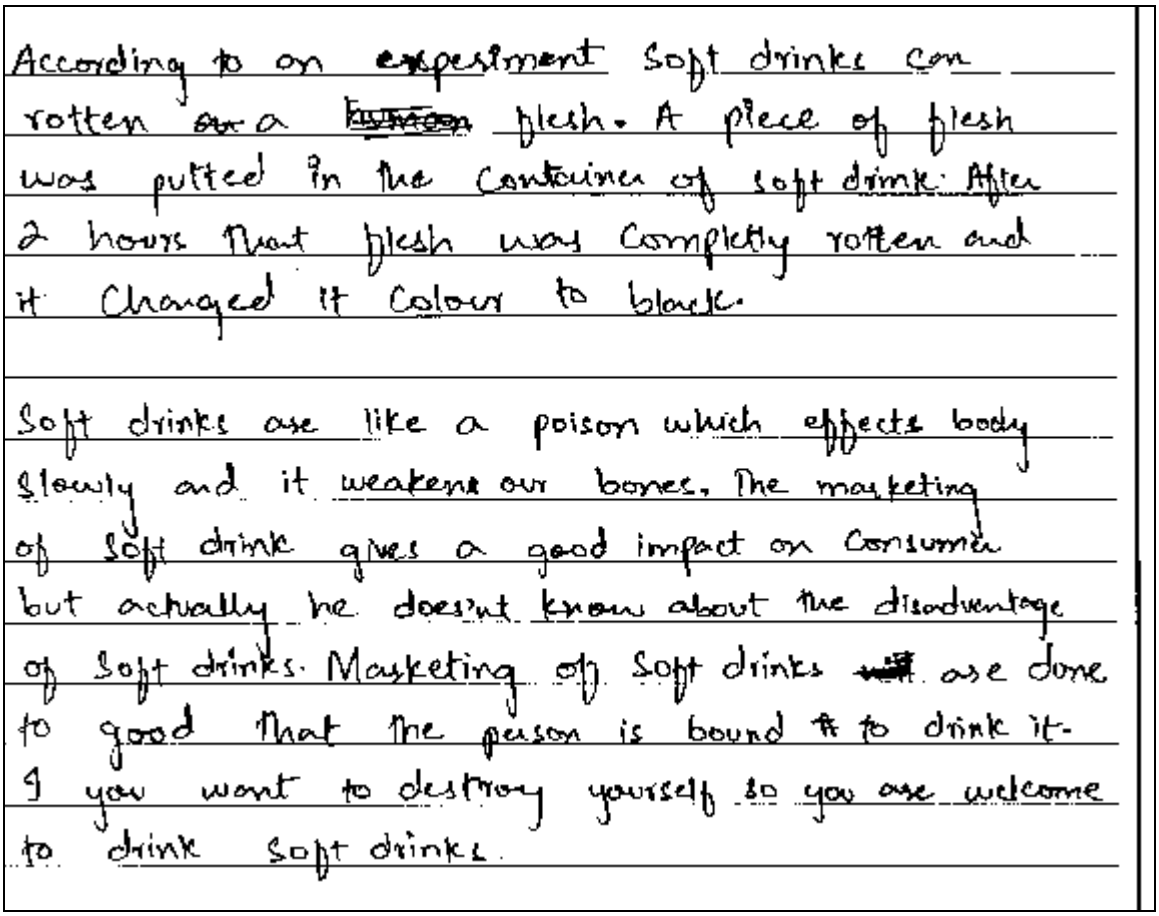
Option a

Soft drinks are drinks made up of Coda ~~and~~ food Colour and different Chemicals. Soft drinks are dangerous for our healthy lifes. It is a main reasons for the lack of Calcium in a human body. The impact of Soft drinks is not very fast, its slowly effect the human body.

Soft drinks should be limited because it has many disadvantages for human body. People drink it for good taste only. It has become a traditional in our Country to save Soft drink for guests. Soft drinks Cause a Stomach gas. The Carbon dioxide gas present in Soft drink effect the person Stomach, which leads in bad smell for others.

The Chemicals used in making of Soft drinks like Caffine are Very dangerous for our health. The food Colour also effects the human body. According to research in KU Soft drinks Can also be Used as a washroom cleaner or drain opening.

Soft drinks are also used to kill pesticides. Some Soft drinks are drunk by people. How badly it will effect our body.



According to an experiment Soft drinks can rotten as a human flesh. A piece of flesh was putted in the Container of soft drink. After 2 hours that flesh was Completly rotten and it Changed it Colour to black.

Soft drinks are like a poison which effects body slowly and it weakens our bones. The marketing of Soft drink gives a good impact on Consumer but actually he doesn't know about the disadvantage of Soft drinks. Marketing of Soft drinks are done to good that the person is bound to drink it. If you want to destroy yourself so you are welcome to drink Soft drinks.

Question 4b:

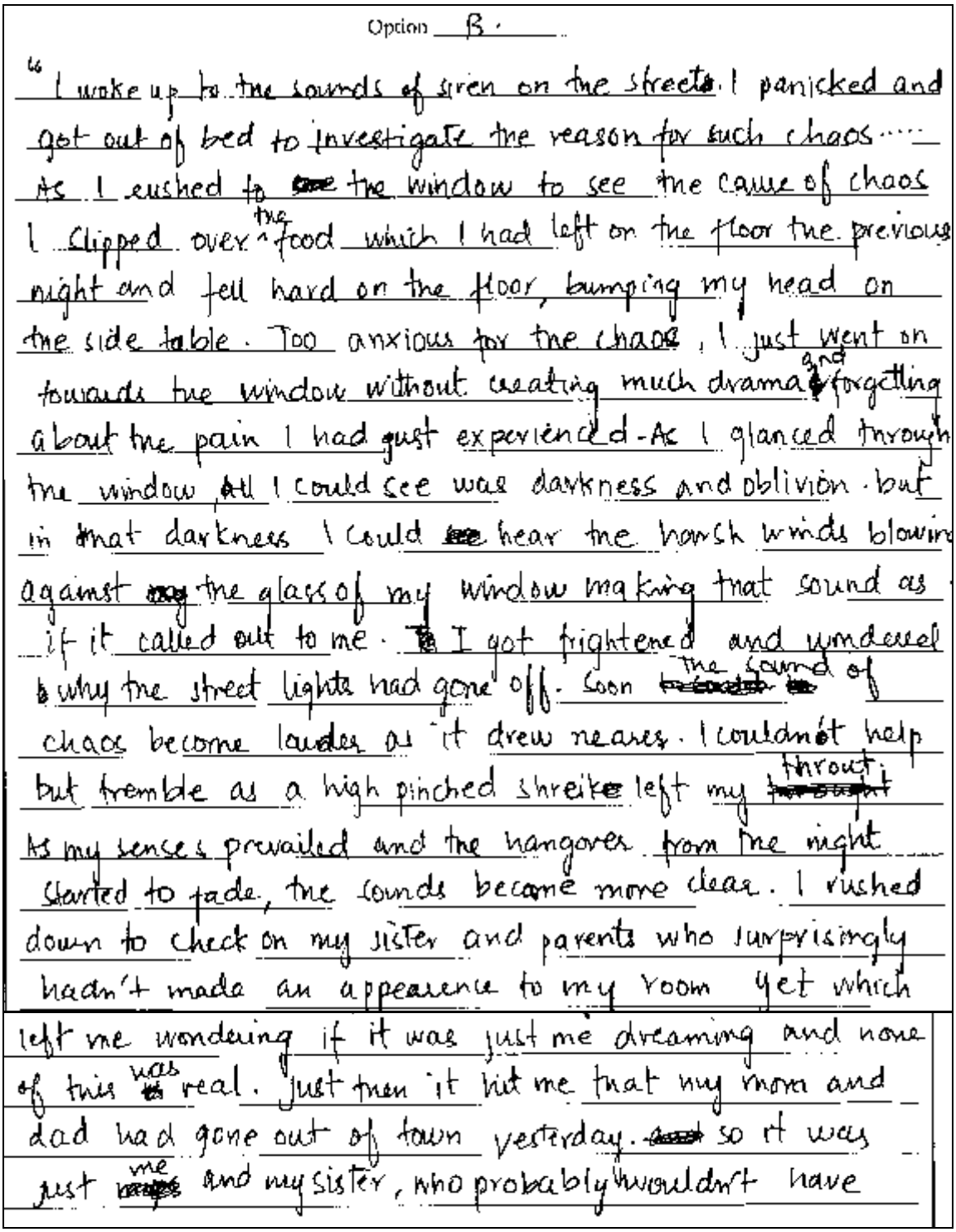
"I woke up to the sounds of sirens on the street. I panicked and got out of bed to investigate the reason for such chaos…"

Narrate a story starting with the given sentences.

Better responses were observed to have

- a strong beginning that drew attention of the reader by creating an atmosphere of suspense and drama.
- sensory details that made the reader feel like they are sharing in the author's experience.
- numerous emotions through the use of dialogue between characters as well as through the internal thoughts of characters. The candidates included descriptive words meant to show rather than describe the emotions they were going through in the imagined situation.
- showcased a remarkable understanding of the organisation/ structure of a narrative essay by observing a proper beginning, climax and conclusion.

Example:



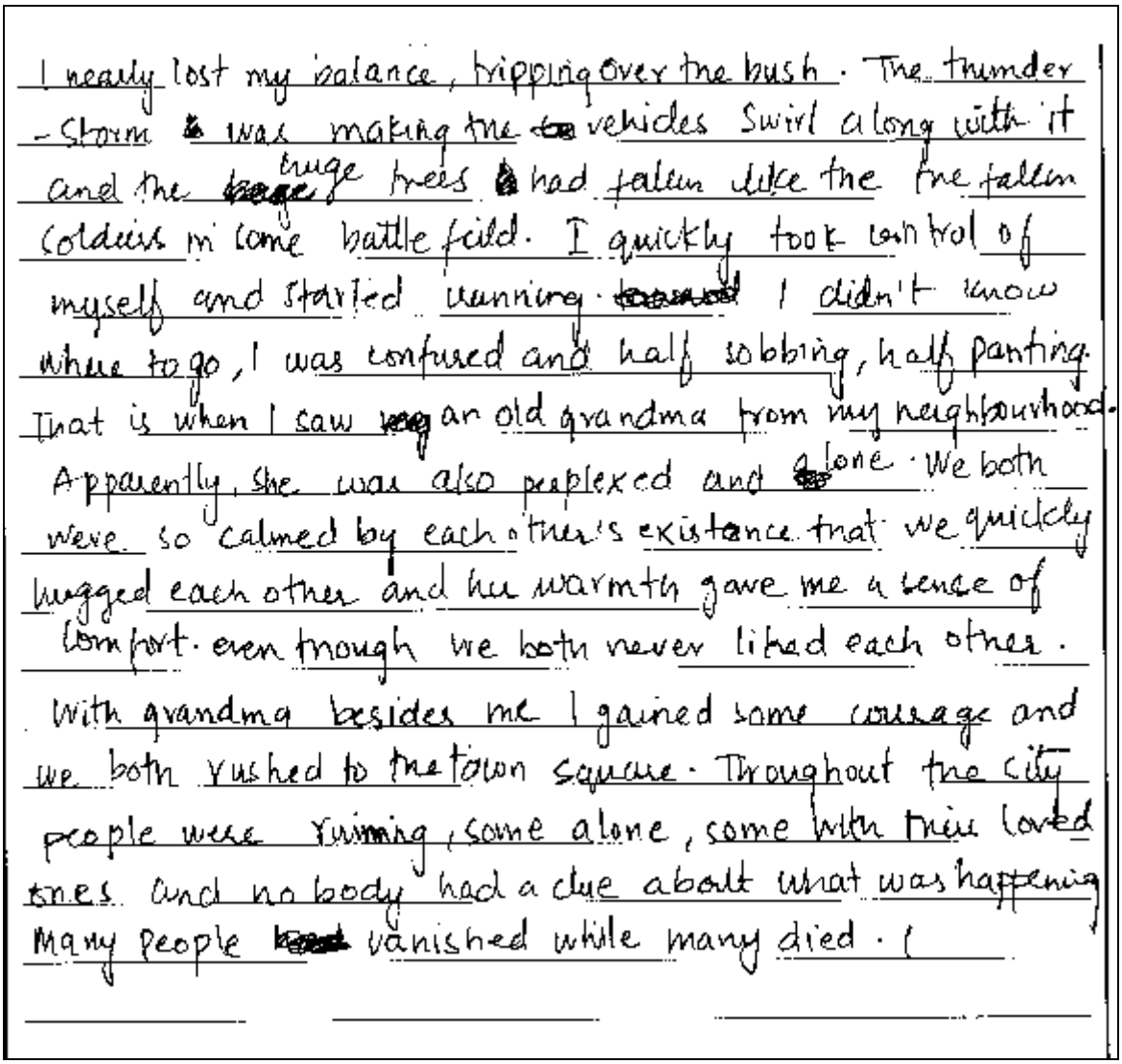
Option B.

"I woke up to the sounds of siren on the streets. I panicked and got out of bed to investigate the reason for such chaos..... As I rushed to the window to see the cause of chaos I tripped over the food which I had left on the floor the previous night and fell hard on the floor, bumping my head on the side table. Too anxious for the chaos, I just went on towards the window without creating much drama and forgetting about the pain I had just experienced. As I glanced through the window all I could see was darkness and oblivion. but in that darkness I could hear the harsh winds blowing against the glass of my window making that sound as if it called out to me. I got frightened and wondered why the street lights had gone off. Soon the sound of chaos become louder as it drew neares. I couldn't help but tremble as a high pinched shreike left my throut. As my senses prevailed and the hangover from the night started to fade, the sounds became more clear. I rushed down to check on my sister and parents who surprisingly hadn't made an appearence to my room yet which left me wondering if it was just me dreaming and none of this was real. Just then it hit me that my mom and dad had gone out of town yesterday. so it was just me and my sister, who probably wouldn't have

woken up because she sleeps like a corpse. The thought of being alone in the house with my sister in such a chaotic situation gave me goose bumps. As I entered my sister's room, to my surprise she was not there and I started looking for her around the house, screaming her name as it slowly burst into tears and I couldn't stop myself from crying. I reminded myself I had to stay strong and think wisely. While the sounds, now accompanying with sirens and people shouting and screaming, grew louder so I decided to leave the house and go to some place safer, surrounded by more people.

As I approached the main entrance, I noticed that the door was half open and the shoes and keys were in a condition which seemed as if someone had panickly handled them. As I got my shoes and took some important stuff in my bag pack, I though maybe it was my sister who might have left the house from the sound of chaos but why did she left me? Why didn't she bother to care about her younger sister? Such thoughts troubled me on the inside as some really dangerous thoughts invaded my mind regarding my sister.

As soon as I left the house, the strong and fierce wind blew against my cheeks as if it was slapping me and trying to

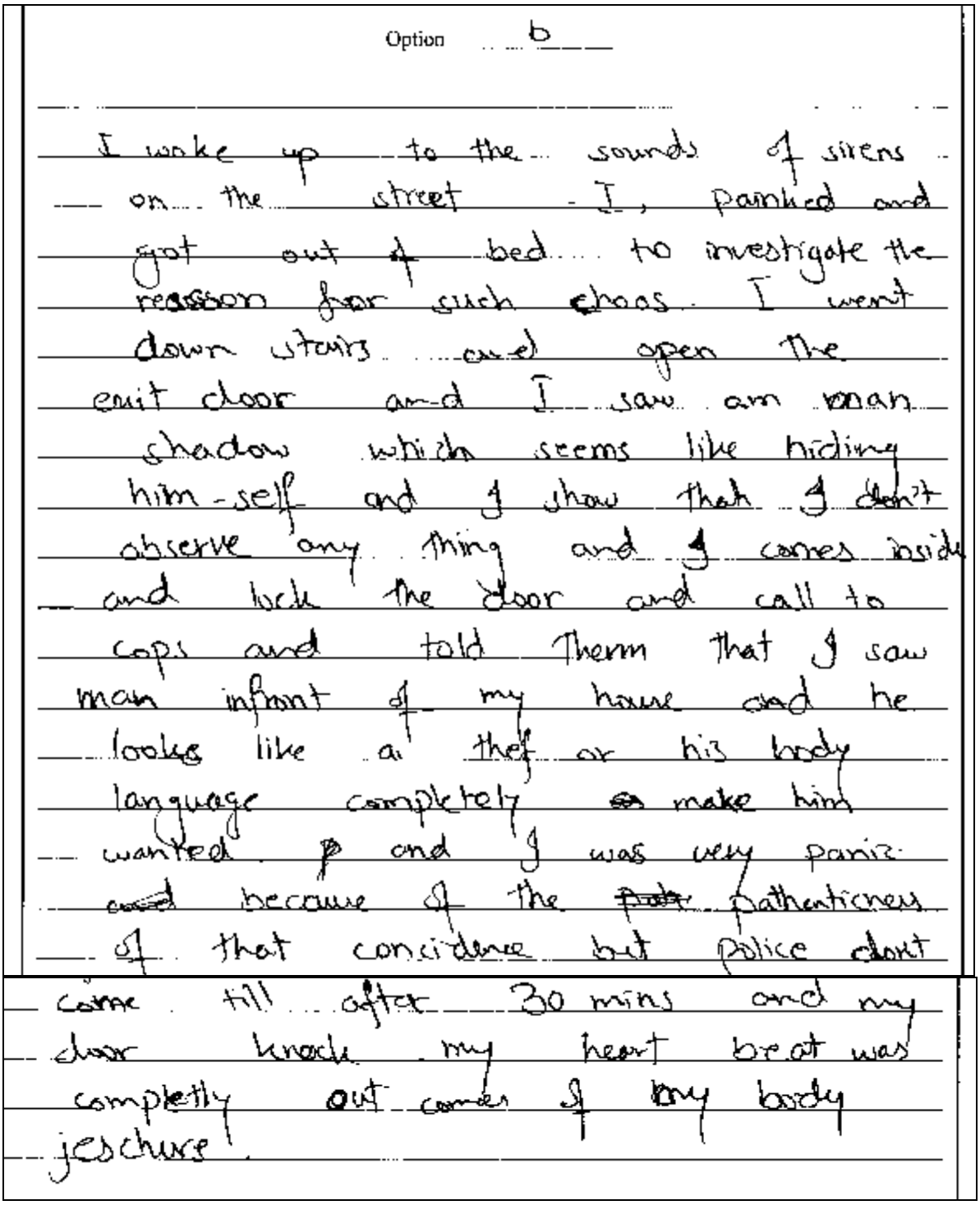


I nearly lost my balance, tripping over the bush. The thunder-storm was making the vehicles swirl along with it and the huge trees had fallen like the fallen soldiers in some battle field. I quickly took control of myself and started running. I didn't know where to go, I was confused and half sobbing, half panting. That is when I saw an old grandma from my neighbourhood. Apparently, she was also perplexed and alone. We both were so calmed by each other's existance that we quickly hugged each other and her warmth gave me a sense of comfort. even though we both never liked each other. With grandma besides me I gained some courage and we both rushed to the town square. Throughout the city people were running, some alone, some with their loved ones. And no body had a clue about what was happening. Many people vanished while many died. (

In the *weaker responses*, the candidates

- did not write a personal narrative, instead offering an overview of what happens when a panic situation occurs.
- mentioned various steps one should take in order to prevent panicking.
- dispayed a lack of cohesion amongst their ideas and the content has issues with inaccurate use of punctuations, sentence structures and spellings.

Example:



Option b

I woke up to the sounds of sirens on the street - I, panked and got out of bed to investigate the reasson for such chaos. I went down stairs and open the exit door and I saw am man shadow which seems like hiding him-self and I show that I don't observe any thing and I comes inside and lock the door and call to cops and told Therm that I saw man infront of my house and he looks like a thef or his body language completely make him wanted and I was very panic because of the pathenticness of that concidence but police dont come till after 30 mins and my door knock my heart beat was completly out comes of my body jeschure.

My steps towards the door and his knocking The door is not less horror Then a film in cerema. I had a shotgun in my house which I don't know who to shoot but steel I had it in my hand and I open the door there is no one in front of me and its more scaring me that who knocks the door then a man rapidly attacks on me with his axe in his hand but its my goodness that my shotgun trigen gose down and bolit come out and shot him on his neck and he lay down on my house floor the cobs come and Thuestigate and afeter inestigation they epreshede me That this man was wanted and ran before 3 months.

I think it is a single experience which don't forgetable

Question 4c:

According to James Clear, “The basic idea is that the beliefs you have about yourself can drive your long-term behaviour. Maybe you can trick yourself into going to the gym or eating healthy once or twice, but if you don’t shift your underlying identity, then it’s hard to stick with long-term changes.” Hence, many people are hesitant to change their habits.

Narrate about a time when you tried to change a bad habit. In you narration, include

- what prompted you to change your habit.
- what steps did you take.
- what was the outcome.

Better responses demonstrated

- a variety of sentence structures to communicate their ideas.
- employed proper punctuation, spellings and grammar.
- mentioned techniques such as re-evaluating/ reassessing/ critically observing themselves that changed their behaviour from good to bad.
- most bad behaviours included overstepping their boundaries, procrastination and being quick to jump into conclusions.

Example:

Option C

Think how boring life would be if nothing challenging ever happens to us. We would never learn and never change. Challenging the challenges life offer us and ~~changing~~ shifting paradigms is real living. Changing a bad habit for a good one is the hardest thing I have ever done for my teenage soul.

~~the~~ famous Paulo Coelho quotes "Believe even if no one else believes in you." But I was lucky enough to have a friend who believed in me and fuel up me saying that you can do it because you are born to beat the best. and sure enough you can defeat your bad habit in the battle of life. These words got etched to my heart mind and soul and I took the first step to exchange my habit of not showing my creative skills and my art to the world out there. I had a low self esteem and I never believed in myself. I would not participate in class or any co-curricular activities conducted in our school and I would think of myself as a burden on the planet earth. who is capable of doing nothing. ~~In~~ After coming back home from school I used to go straight to my room

and lockup myself. When my friends would call me to join them in the art studio nearby I would refuse simply saying that my brother is expecting me to play with him or something else.

Once one of my friends observed me very deeply and came to visit me at my home. He came to my room and saw all of the paintings on the walls of my room and the calligraphy and other peices of art with which my room was decorated. He asked if they were mine. I nodded saying 'Yes'. Then he talked to me and discovered the reasons (unappreciated) to my fear of being not accepted and other reasons of not showing my art to everyone. Then when he incouraged me, I tried to shift my pradigms. He gave me his book '7 Habits of Highly effective teenagers' which I call Bible of teenagers & now. It helped me to be confident and bost my self esteem. And I exchanged my bad habit, ~~for of fearing the things~~ hidding my self for exposing my self.

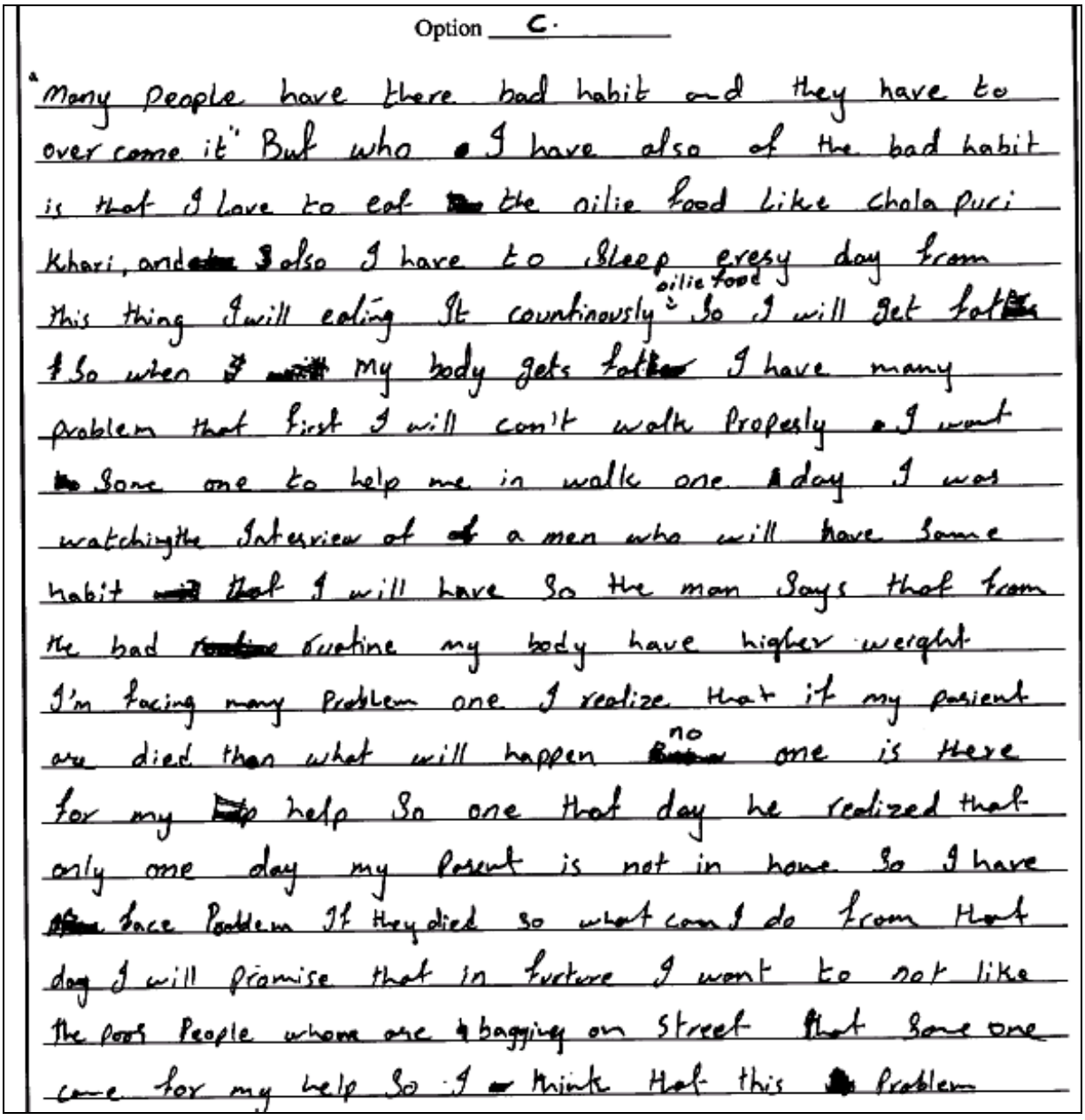
In the following months I attended regional

and national camps. There I showed my year book (peice of my art) to the participants during activities. I also developed intellectual skills. Now I am president of Art club and vice president of literature club at my school. Moreover I am the event organiser and I decorate all the stages at our school for different events taking place. In addition I am also running a page on social media of my art and I have volunteered for doing work related to art and calligraphy in different camps. And this change came into my way only because of that one person who believed in me and lit the fire of friendship for me when a cold wind was blowing through my life.

At the end of the day the thing which matter in life is what ~~you~~ we do about the bad things and how ~~you~~ we handle the situations. And coping with challenges life bestows us is a great deal. Though its roots are bitter, ~~but~~ the fruit we recieve at the end is very sweet. We only need to take a single step and start the journey of Change.

Weaker Responses did not exhibit internal consistency in their writing. This was observed due to the fact that the candidates missed either the steps taken to change their behaviour or failed to mention the conclusion/ outcome after improving their behavioural pattern(s). Some responses showed a lack of focus in the middle of the essay and concluding with a completely irrelevant outcome which was not required.

Example:



Option C.

"Many People have there bad habit and they have to over come it" But who I have also of the bad habit is that I Love to eat the oilie food Like chola puri Khari, and also I have to Sleep eresy day from oilie food this thing I will eating It countinously So I will get fat So when my body gets fat I have many problem that first I will can't walk Propesly I want Some one to help me in walk one day I was watching the Interview of a men who will have Some habit that I will have So the man Says that from the bad routine my body have higher weight I'm facing many Problem one I realize that if my parient no are died than what will happen one is Here for my help So one that day he realized that only one day my Parent is not in home So I have face Problem If they died so what can I do from that day I will Promise that in future I want to not like the poor People whome are bagging on Street that Some one come for my help So I think that this Problem

can't apply on me. So know onward I will Stop eating oilie food and make my health betters. after that interview I will also realized that in furture I will can't face the same Problem on the second day I will start going gym and do the extra curreculer activity to lose my weight. and Solved the Problem and know many of people come and take advise from me. If you have to Stop the Cirgrate habit or any habit You Pu take those person to the hospital and Saw the person that If you can't Stop doing this thing You have to face this Problem. So every on is Stop doing those bad habit